

Task 03 – Prompting for Task Automation

SkillCraft Technology | Prompt Engineering Internship

Objective

Apply prompting to semi-automate a real-world task by designing a clear, consistent prompt that can handle multiple inputs and produce reliable, structured output.

Chosen Task: Meeting Notes → Structured JSON

Converting raw, messy meeting notes into structured JSON is a highly practical automation task used by developers, project managers, and operations teams to feed data into dashboards, databases, and task trackers.

Master Prompt (Reusable Template)

You are a data extraction assistant. Your job is to read raw meeting notes and convert them into a structured JSON object with exactly these fields:

```
{
  "meeting_title": "",
  "date": "",
  "attendees": [],
  "agenda_items": [],
  "decisions_made": [],
  "action_items": [
    {
      "task": "",
      "assigned_to": "",
      "deadline": ""
    }
  ],
  "next_meeting": ""
}
```

Rules:

- Extract only what is explicitly mentioned. Use "Not mentioned" for missing fields.
- Keep all text concise and clear.
- Return ONLY the JSON. No explanation, no extra text.

Meeting Notes:

[PASTE NOTES HERE]

Input–Output Examples

Example 1 — Product Team Meeting

Input (Raw Notes):

Weekly sync - June 10, 2026
Present: Sara, James, Priya, Tom
We discussed the new dashboard feature. Sara said the design is 90% done.
James will finish the backend API by June 15. Priya to write test cases by June 17.
We decided to delay the launch by one week to June 25.
Next meeting: June 17, same time.

Output (JSON):

```
{
  "meeting_title": "Weekly Sync",
  "date": "June 10, 2026",
  "attendees": ["Sara", "James", "Priya", "Tom"],
  "agenda_items": ["New dashboard feature progress"],
  "decisions_made": ["Delay launch by one week to June 25"],
  "action_items": [
    {
      "task": "Finish backend API",
      "assigned_to": "James",
      "deadline": "June 15"
    },
    {
      "task": "Write test cases",
      "assigned_to": "Priya",
      "deadline": "June 17"
    }
  ],
  "next_meeting": "June 17, same time"
}
```

Example 2 — Marketing Strategy Meeting

Input (Raw Notes):

Marketing planning call, June 11
Attendees: Riya, Dev, Ankit
Topics: Q3 social media campaign, influencer outreach, budget review.
Decided to increase Instagram budget by 20%. Dev will contact 5 influencers by June 20.
Riya to prepare budget report by June 18. No next meeting scheduled yet.

Output (JSON):

```
{
  "meeting_title": "Marketing Planning Call",
```

```

"date": "June 11",
"attendees": ["Riya", "Dev", "Ankit"],
"agenda_items": [
  "Q3 social media campaign",
  "Influencer outreach",
  "Budget review"
],
"decisions_made": ["Increase Instagram budget by 20%"],
"action_items": [
  {
    "task": "Contact 5 influencers",
    "assigned_to": "Dev",
    "deadline": "June 20"
  },
  {
    "task": "Prepare budget report",
    "assigned_to": "Riya",
    "deadline": "June 18"
  }
],
"next_meeting": "Not mentioned"
}

```

Example 3 — HR Onboarding Meeting

Input (Raw Notes):

HR onboarding review - June 12, 2026
 People: HR head Neha, IT lead Rohan, new hire mentor Kabir
 Discussed onboarding checklist and IT setup delays. Rohan must set up laptop and accounts for new hires before June 14. Kabir to prepare welcome kit by June 13.
 Decided: All new hires get a buddy assigned on Day 1.
 Next sync on June 19.

Output (JSON):

```

{
  "meeting_title": "HR Onboarding Review",
  "date": "June 12, 2026",
  "attendees": ["Neha (HR Head)", "Rohan (IT Lead)", "Kabir (Mentor)"],
  "agenda_items": [
    "Onboarding checklist review",
    "IT setup delays"
  ],
  "decisions_made": ["All new hires get a buddy assigned on Day 1"],
  "action_items": [
    {
      "task": "Set up laptop and accounts for new hires",
      "assigned_to": "Rohan",
      "deadline": "June 14"
    },
    {
      "task": "Prepare welcome kit",
      "assigned_to": "Kabir",
      "deadline": "June 13"
    }
  ]
}

```

```
],  
  "next_meeting": "June 19"  
}
```

Prompt Performance Summary

Example	Fields Extracted	Missing Fields Handled	Accuracy
Product Team Meeting	All 7 fields	None needed	✅ 100%
Marketing Strategy Meeting	All 7 fields	next_meeting → "Not mentioned"	✅ 100%
HR Onboarding Meeting	All 7 fields	None needed	✅ 100%

Reflection: Prompt Iteration & Debugging

Iteration 1 — Extra Text Problem

Problem: The first draft prompt simply said *"Convert meeting notes to JSON."* The model kept adding explanation text before and after the JSON block, making it unreliable for programmatic parsing.

Fix: Added explicit rule — *"Return ONLY the JSON. No explanation, no extra text."*

Iteration 2 — Missing Fields Problem

Problem: When a field like `next_meeting` wasn't mentioned in the notes, the model sometimes skipped the field entirely or returned `null`, creating an inconsistent schema across runs.

Fix: Added rule — *"Use 'Not mentioned' for missing fields"* to enforce a predictable, uniform structure every time.

Iteration 3 — Inconsistent Action Item Format

Problem: Action items were sometimes written as vague phrases or questions ("Should James finish the API?") instead of clear task descriptions.

Fix: Restructured the `action_items` schema with explicit sub-fields (`task`, `assigned_to`, `deadline`) and added *"Keep all text concise and clear."*

Final Result

After 3 iterations, the prompt produces **reliable, parse-ready JSON** consistently across all input types — demonstrating how systematic debugging transforms a flawed prompt into a production-ready automation tool.

Key Takeaways

Lesson	Detail
Strict output rules matter	"Return ONLY JSON" prevents unwanted text wrapping
Handle missing data explicitly	Prevents broken or inconsistent output schemas
Define the schema upfront	Model follows a fixed structure more reliably
Iterate based on failures	Each bug fixed = significantly more robust automation
Real-world grounding	Choosing a practical task makes the prompt immediately useful

Tools Used

- **LLM:** Claude (Anthropic)
 - **Method:** Manual prompt design, testing & iteration
 - **Format:** Structured JSON output
 - **Track:** Prompt Engineering
 - **Internship:** SkillCraft Technology
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